



Cultural Plan for the City of McDonough, Georgia

2026 through 2031



McDONOUGH
THE GERANIUM CITY

**City of McDonough
Office of the Mayor
136 Keys Ferry Street
McDonough, Georgia 30253**

October 17, 2025

Dear Members of the McDonough City Council, Cultural Partners, and Residents,

It is my privilege to present the DRAFT *Cultural Plan for the City of McDonough, Georgia — 2026 through 2031*. This plan represents a milestone in our city's continued growth as a place where history, creativity, and community come together to shape our shared future.

McDonough has always taken pride in its heritage and the strength of its people. Our downtown square, our neighborhoods, and our cultural institutions remind us that our story is not just something we preserve—it is something we continue to write. The Cultural Plan lays out a clear roadmap for the next five years, one that builds upon our historic character while opening new opportunities for art, learning, and public participation.

Through this plan, we will:

- Honor and protect McDonough's unique cultural and historical assets;
- Support local artists, educators, and creative entrepreneurs;
- Expand access to arts and cultural experiences for all residents; and
- Strengthen the role of culture as a driver of tourism, education, and economic vitality.

I am proud of the collaboration that shaped this document. It reflects the input of community members, cultural organizations, schools, and civic partners who share a deep love for McDonough. I especially wish to thank Museum Planning, LLC and Mark Walhimer for their professional leadership and dedication in guiding this effort.

As Mayor, I am committed to seeing this plan fully implemented. With your continued partnership, we can ensure that McDonough remains not only a beautiful and historic city but also a creative, inclusive, and forward-looking one.

Together, let us celebrate our heritage, empower our artists, and create a cultural legacy worthy of future generations.

With appreciation and optimism,
Sincerely,

Mayor Sandra Vincent
Mayor, City of McDonough, Georgia

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Executive Summary

City of McDonough Cultural Plan 2026–2031

The *Cultural Plan for the City of McDonough, Georgia (2026–2031)* provides a five-year roadmap to strengthen McDonough’s cultural identity, creative economy, and community life. It reflects the shared vision of residents, artists, educators, and civic leaders who believe that McDonough’s heritage and creativity are central to its future prosperity.

Vision

McDonough will be a vibrant, inclusive cultural community — where the past is celebrated, creative expression thrives, and culture strengthens community identity, connectivity, and opportunity for all residents and visitors.

This plan positions culture as essential civic infrastructure — a foundation for economic vitality, education, and civic pride.

Purpose

The Cultural Plan unites the city’s arts, heritage, and community initiatives under one coordinated strategy.

It aligns local assets — museums, schools, artists, and neighborhoods — with public investment and private partnerships to achieve measurable outcomes in cultural participation, education, and economic development.

Strategic Pillars

1. **Heritage & Place-Making**

Preserve and activate historic buildings, neighborhoods, and cultural landmarks through restoration, adaptive reuse, and storytelling.

2. **Arts, Creativity & Community Expression**

Support artists, creative entrepreneurs, and community programs that make arts accessible to everyone.

3. **Culture, Economy & Tourism**

Integrate culture into the city’s economic development, tourism marketing, and downtown revitalization.

4. **Community Engagement & Equity**

Ensure every resident, neighborhood, and demographic group has equal access to cultural opportunities.

Implementation Framework

The plan establishes a **Cultural Steering Committee** and appoints a **Cultural Coordinator** to oversee implementation.

It organizes work through annual milestones and measurable outcomes, supported by a dedicated **Cultural Investment Fund**.

Five-Year Milestones

Year	Focus	Highlights
2026	Foundation	Launch Steering Committee, Cultural Fund, and branding (“Creative McDonough”)
2027	Visibility	Public art, youth programs, and first cultural grants
2028	Expansion	Inaugural <i>McDonough Arts & Heritage Festival</i>
2029	Integration	Creative Summit, tourism partnerships, and neighborhood initiatives
2030–31	Legacy	Opening of Creative Hub, AR heritage trail, and Five-Year Cultural Audit

Funding & Partnerships

Estimated annual investment: **\$250,000–\$400,000**, combining:

- **City allocations and hotel/motel tax revenue**
- **State & federal grants** (NEA, GCA, DCA, Georgia Humanities)
- **Private foundations and corporate sponsorships**
- **Earned income** (festivals, workshops, rentals)

Key partners include the **City of McDonough, Main Street McDonough, Henry County Convention & Visitors Bureau, Henry County Parks and Recreation, C.O. Polk Interactive Museum, Hood Street Art Center, Henry County Schools, and Georgia Council for the Arts.**

Evaluation & Accountability

Success will be measured through annual reporting and a public dashboard tracking key metrics:

- **250 artists supported** through grants and residencies
- **25 heritage sites restored or interpreted**
- **50,000 annual cultural visitors**
- **\$1 million in annual tourism impact**
- **2:1 leverage ratio of external to City funds**
- **80% resident satisfaction** with McDonough’s cultural life

Annual public forums and a Five-Year Audit in 2031 will ensure transparency and guide the next planning cycle.

Outcome

By 2031, McDonough will have:

- A thriving downtown cultural district,
- A sustainable funding model for arts and heritage,
- Expanded creative workforce opportunities,
- A reputation as a regional hub for innovation and inclusion.

The *Cultural Plan 2026–2031* celebrates what makes McDonough unique — its heritage, its creativity, and its people — ensuring that culture remains central to the city’s identity and future growth.

1. Background & Context

1.1 City's Cultural & Historical Assets

- McDonough's historic downtown square, courthouse and the local historic district lend the city a strong heritage-anchor.
- The city hosts museums such as the C.O. Polk Museum (34 John Frank Ward Blvd) and the Camera Museum (369 Macon St).
- The downtown zoning ordinance emphasizes creating a “vital downtown ... strongly grounded in their cultural heritage.”
- The city is working on neighborhood cultural/heritage planning (e.g., the Blacksville neighborhood plan) that emphasises historic Black community identity and placemaking. ([Georgia Conservancy](#))
- The region's arts & culture sector has been profiled in regional cultural assessments (for Henry County). ([Atlanta Regional Commission](#))
- The 2023 Comprehensive Plan Update for McDonough includes an “Arts and Cultural Facilities Plan” component. ([Atlanta Regional Documents](#))

1.2 Why a Cultural Plan Now?

- To **maximize the value** of cultural heritage, arts, creative industries and community identity in the city's future growth and downtown revitalization.
- To **link culture to economic, social, and place-making outcomes**: jobs, tourism, quality of life, community pride, and equitable access to culture.
- To **provide a structured roadmap** 2026-2031 with measurable goals, strategies and actions.
- To **ensure coordination** among city government, arts organizations, heritage groups, neighborhoods, business community and citizens.
- To build on existing momentum (downtown redevelopment, neighborhood plans, historic district protections) and align with broader planning frameworks.

1.3 Vision Statement

“McDonough will be a vibrant, inclusive cultural community — where the past is celebrated, creative expression thrives, and culture strengthens community identity, connectivity and opportunity for all residents and visitors.”

2. Strategic Pillars & Goals

The plan is structured around four strategic pillars. Under each, we define 1-2 goals and key strategies.

Pillar A: Heritage & Place-Making

Goal A1. Preserve and activate McDonough’s historic built environment, neighborhoods, and cultural landscapes.

Goal A2. Use culture and heritage as catalysts for place-making — making downtown and neighborhoods more vibrant, walkable, and appealing.

Key Strategies:

- Strengthen historic district protections and guidelines (building on the 1993 ordinance). ([Georgia Department of Natural Resources](#))
- Develop guided heritage trails, walking tours and interpretive signage throughout downtown and key neighborhoods.
- Incorporate public art, murals, and creative installations in public spaces (downtown, parks, neighbourhoods) tied to local heritage themes.
- Support neighborhood cultural planning (e.g., Blacksville) to celebrate historic Black neighborhoods and ensure equitable investment and cultural recognition. ([Georgia Conservancy](#))
- Encourage adaptive reuse of older buildings for cultural uses (galleries, performance spaces, studios) to bring new vitality.

Pillar B: Arts, Creativity & Community Expression

Goal B1. Expand opportunities for artistic creation, creative entrepreneurship, and community-based cultural expression.

Goal B2. Make arts and culture accessible and inclusive across all demographic groups.

Key Strategies:

- Partner with local galleries (e.g., the HoodStreet Art Center, Windsor Gallery) and cultural organizations to expand programming. ([McDonough GA](#))
- Establish an artist-in-residence or cultural incubator program in McDonough to support emerging artists and creative entrepreneurs.
- Create public performance series (music, theatre, dance) in downtown, parks, and neighbourhoods.
- Offer cultural programming (workshops, classes, festivals) that reflect the diversity of the community and support participation of historically-under-served populations.
- Encourage creative industry businesses (design, publishing, visual arts) to locate or grow in McDonough — tapping into the county’s creative industries data. ([Atlanta Regional Commission](#))

Pillar C: Culture, Economy & Tourism

Goal C1. Strengthen the cultural economy: tourism, creative businesses, cultural events, and heritage tourism.

Goal C2. Leverage culture to enhance downtown economic vitality, neighbourhood investment, and quality of life.

Key Strategies:

- Develop a signature annual cultural festival or event (or series) that draws regional visitors and showcases local arts, heritage, and food.
- Create cultural-tourism packages tied to McDonough’s heritage (e.g., Historic District walking tour, museum visits, downtown shopping, dining) to draw visitors from metro-Atlanta. ([Explore Georgia](#))
- Collaborate with Main Street McDonough, the downtown business community, and hospitality/tourism stakeholders to position culture as an asset for place branding.
- Encourage mixed-use development around downtown and neighbourhoods with cultural amenities to stimulate investment, property value retention and new business. (Echoed in the Downtown Zoning Ordinance) ([McDonough GA](#))
- Track cultural sector job growth, visitor numbers, arts business growth as part of metrics.

Pillar D: Community Engagement & Equity

Goal D1. Ensure broad community engagement, ownership and equitable access to cultural opportunities across McDonough.

Goal D2. Support culture as a tool for community cohesion, identity-building, youth development and social impact.

Key Strategies:

- Facilitate regular cultural-planning forums, citizen advisory committees, and participatory processes to ensure community voices shape cultural initiatives (echoing Blacksville plan process). ([Georgia Conservancy](#))
 - Ensure Programing in multiple parts of the city — not just downtown — to reach all neighborhoods.
 - Partner with schools, youth organizations, and non-profits to embed arts and culture into youth development and community programs.
 - Implement outreach and programs specifically aimed at underrepresented populations, neighborhood groups, and historically marginalized communities.
 - Monitor and evaluate cultural accessibility (transportation, affordability, language, etc.) and adjust programming accordingly.
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3. Action Plan by Time-Phases (2026-2031)

To provide focus, the timeframe is split into **short term (2026-27)**, **mid term (2028-29)**, and **long term (2030-31)**. Each period includes key actions under each pillar.

3.1 Short Term (2026-27)

Heritage & Place-Making

- Undertake a complete inventory of historic/cultural assets city-wide (buildings, districts, neighbourhoods, public art) to update the baseline.
- Launch a pilot walking/historic-trail in downtown (with interpretive signage).
- Commission a public art piece in a visible downtown or park location.

Arts, Creativity, Community Expression

- Convene a steering committee of artists, cultural organizations, business and city staff to develop a “Creative McDonough” framework (artist-in-residence, cultural incubator, grants program).
- Expand gallery and arts programming in downtown (e.g., monthly art-walk, pop-up studios).

Culture/Economy/Tourism

- Define a signature annual cultural festival concept (theme, location, partners) and plan for launch in 2027.
- Create a cultural-tourism marketing plan: branding, partner with tourism board, highlight McDonough’s heritage, museums, downtown, and festivals.

Community Engagement & Equity

- Launch a city-wide “Culture & Community” survey to understand resident needs, preferences, barriers and priorities.
- Start neighbourhood cultural outreach sessions (e.g., priority neighborhoods like Blacksville) to gather input and co-design local cultural activation.
- Ensure accessibility audit of cultural spaces (transportation, ADA, affordability) is completed.

3.2 Mid Term (2028-29)

Heritage & Place-Making

- Roll out neighborhood heritage circuits beyond downtown (e.g., historic Black neighbourhoods, heritage corridors) and map them year-by-year.
- Begin façade improvement grants for historic buildings in downtown and key corridors to support adaptive reuse for cultural/creative uses.

Arts, Creativity, Community Expression

- Launch the artist-in-residence and cultural incubator program; provide open studios, creative-business workshops, and micro-grants to local creatives.
- Host a mid-term “McDonough Creative Summit” — a two-day gathering of regional artists, creatives, arts organizations, business and city leaders to share best practices, build networks and raise profile.

Culture/Economy/Tourism

- Launch the signature festival in 2028 with full program, plug into tourism marketing; measure attendance, visitor economic impact, local business participation.
- Offer cultural business incentives (e.g., tax relief, façade grants, rent-subsidy for creative tenants) to attract creative economy firms.
- Expand partnerships with hospitality, other cities, the region for cultural tourism packages (heritage + arts + dining + shopping).

Community Engagement & Equity

- Deploy youth cultural programs: summer arts camps, mentorship with local creatives, neighborhood mural projects.
- Ensure cultural programming in underserved neighbourhoods includes dedicated budget and measurement of reach.
- Launch an annual “Culture for All” award/recognition to celebrate inclusive cultural practices in McDonough.

3.3 Long Term (2030-31)

Heritage & Place-Making

- Consolidate McDonough’s role as a regional cultural destination by enhancing way-finding, signage, digital-app historic tours, augmented reality experiences in historic district and heritage sites.
- Evaluate and expand public-art network city-wide (e.g., sculpture trails, heritage murals) linking parks, downtown and neighborhoods.

Arts, Creativity, Community Expression

- Expand the cultural incubator into a permanent Creative Hub (studio space, co-work, maker-space) for local artists and entrepreneurs.
- Position McDonough as a host for regional arts events (festivals, exhibitions, performances) collaborating with metro-Atlanta partners.

Culture/Economy/Tourism

- Achieve measurable increases in: cultural sector employment, number of cultural businesses, visitor numbers to McDonough, downtown retail occupancy and cultural venue utilisation.
- Launch a multi-year “Cultural District” designation for downtown McDonough (if not yet in place) to leverage state/federal support, public art investment, cultural financing tools.
- Integrate culture fully into city’s economic development plan and downtown redevelopment strategy (e.g. mixed-use developments with cultural/creative anchor).

Community Engagement & Equity

- Regularly review and ensure cultural programming remains equitable: monitor diversity of participants, geographic spread, access for youth and historically-under-served communities.
 - Develop an endowment or cultural trust fund to support long-term sustainability of cultural initiatives, and ensure continuity beyond elections or annual budget cycles.
 - Evaluate the cultural plan’s success via an independent cultural-sector audit, and update the plan through community co-design for the next 5-year period.
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4. Implementation & Governance

4.1 Roles & Responsibilities

- The City’s cultural plan should be overseen by a **Cultural Steering Committee**, comprised of city staff (Planning/Community Development, Economic Development, Parks & Recreation, Historic Preservation), arts & heritage organizations, business/downtown stakeholders (Main Street McDonough), neighborhood representatives, and a citizen arts advisory panel.
- The city should designate (or hire) a **Cultural Coordinator** (or use existing staff) tasked with implementation oversight, coordinating partners, tracking metrics, and managing budgets/grants.
- Partner organizations: local museums (C.O. Polk, Camera Museum, Heritage Park), galleries (HoodStreet, Windsor), tourism agencies, schools/youth programs, neighborhood associations (e.g., for Blacksville).
- Use public-private partnerships, grant funding (state arts agency, national arts organizations, heritage funds) and local business sponsorships to support initiatives.

4.2 Budget & Funding

- The plan should establish a **Cultural Investment Fund** for grants, public art commissions, façade improvements, creative business incentives.
- Seek matching grants from state/federal arts & heritage agencies.
- Explore revenue-raising through cultural tourism, festival ticketing, service fees, artist studio rentals, etc.
- Leverage downtown and redevelopment dollars (e.g., façade grants) to support cultural activation of historic buildings.
- Ensure annual budget allocations for the Cultural Coordinator, marketing/branding, community outreach and measurement.

4.3 Metrics & Evaluation

Key performance indicators (KPIs) might include:

- Number of cultural events held annually (festivals, arts-walks, performances)
- Attendance numbers at cultural events and institutions (museums, galleries)
- Number of active artists/creative business enterprises located in McDonough
- Downtown retail/business occupancy rate (especially culture/creative uses)
- Visitor numbers to McDonough (cultural tourism) and economic impact of culture on local economy
- Number and value of façade/rehab grants for historic buildings used for cultural purposes
- Diversity and geographic distribution of participants in cultural programs (youth, neighbourhoods)
- Community satisfaction survey results regarding cultural amenities, access, & pride
- Existence of new cultural infrastructure (studio/incubator space, public art installations, heritage trails)
- Annual review and adjustment of plan in year 5 (2031) with community consultation.

4.4 Risks & Mitigation

- Risk: Insufficient funding → mitigation: pursue multi-source funding, incremental implementation, steward private sponsorships
 - Risk: Cultural initiatives might focus only downtown and miss neighbourhoods → mitigation: include neighbourhood-based actions, equity metrics & outreach
 - Risk: Lack of community buy-in → mitigation: early and continuous engagement, transparent processes, citizen advisory committees
 - Risk: Overreliance on one signature event → mitigation: diversify cultural programming and build robust year-round calendar
 - Risk: Loss of momentum or changes in political leadership → mitigation: embed the Cultural Fund, institutionalise the Cultural Coordinator and Steering Committee, incorporate plan into city's official strategic framework.
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5. Timeline & Milestones (Summary)

Year	Major Milestones
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2026	Establish Steering Committee, hire Cultural Coordinator, conduct asset inventory, community survey, launch pilot downtown heritage trail & public art piece.
2027	Finalise creative-economy framework, launch monthly art-walks, define signature festival concept, outreach into neighbourhoods begins.
2028	Launch signature festival, open artist-in-residence programme, initiate façade grant programme for historic buildings, youth cultural programmes grow.
2029	Host McDonough Creative Summit, expand cultural-tourism marketing, develop creative-business incentives, neighbourhood heritage circuits underway.
2030	Expand Creative Hub / incubator space, landmark public art / AR heritage trail expansions, cultural district designation pursued.
2031	Conduct full review and audit of cultural plan, publish report of outcomes, reset goals for next 5-year cycle, embed plan into next strategic plan.

6. Alignment with City Plans

- The Cultural Plan aligns with the 2023 Comprehensive Plan Update which includes an Arts & Cultural Facilities Plan. ([Atlanta Regional Documents](#))
 - It supports downtown redevelopment and the Main Street approach (organization, promotion, design, economic restructuring) as seen in the Town Square Action Plan. ([McDonough GA](#))
 - It complements downtown zoning objectives of enhancing quality of life, cultural/heritage tourism, and appealing storefronts/public spaces. ([McDonough GA](#))
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7. Next Steps

1. Present this draft cultural plan to the Mayor & Council and relevant city departments for endorsement.
2. Conduct a community workshop (or series) in 2025-26 to gather public input, refine vision/strategies and develop detailed budget.
3. Develop a detailed operating work-plan for 2026 (first year) with responsibilities, budget, timeline and performance metrics.
4. Secure initial funding and set up the Cultural Investment Fund and hire/appoint the Cultural Coordinator.
5. Launch year 1 initiatives (inventory, survey, pilot projects) and publicize early wins to build momentum.

Appendix A — Cultural Plan Members (2026 – 2031)

1. Cultural Plan Steering Committee

(Appointed by McDonough City Council in early 2026; meets quarterly to guide policy and review progress.)

Role / Affiliation	Representative / Example	Responsibilities
Chair	Mayor of McDonough or Council-designated Cultural Liaison	Oversees alignment with city goals; convenes meetings
Vice Chair	Director, Main Street McDonough Program	Coordinates downtown cultural activation and business partnerships
Secretary	City Cultural Coordinator (new staff position)	Records minutes, tracks metrics, maintains project dashboard
City Council Representative	One appointed councilmember	Provides liaison to City Council
Planning & Community Development Department	City Planning Director	Integrates cultural priorities into land use and development policy
Parks & Recreation Department	Recreation Superintendent	Aligns cultural events with park facilities and community spaces

Economic Development Department	Economic Development Manager	Links creative industries to business incentives and tourism strategy
Historic Preservation Commission	Chairperson or designee	Coordinates heritage protection and adaptive reuse initiatives
Tourism / Visitors Bureau Representative	Henry County Convention & Visitors Bureau	Supports marketing and cultural tourism integration
Education Sector Representative	Henry County Schools Fine Arts Coordinator	Connects youth arts and curriculum partnerships
Higher Education Representative	Mercer University or Gordon State College faculty	Promotes academic-community arts collaboration
Museums Representative	Director, C.O. Polk Interactive Museum	Liaison for heritage interpretation and museum programming
Arts & Creative Industries Representative	Local artist or gallery owner (e.g., Hood Street Art Center)	Advises on artist support, exhibitions, residencies
Community & Neighborhood Representative (Downtown)	Resident or business owner	Ensures local perspectives in decision-making
Community & Neighborhood Representative (Blacksville)	Neighborhood Association President or elder	Guides equity and neighborhood heritage initiatives

Youth Representative	McDonough High School student (rotating seat)	Provides youth input on cultural engagement
Faith Community Representative	Local pastor or interfaith council delegate	Promotes cultural inclusion and volunteer networks
Nonprofit / Social Impact Organization Representative	Leader from community nonprofit	Ensures social equity and outreach inclusion
Corporate / Private Sector Representative	Local business leader or developer	Supports sponsorships and creative-economy investment
County Liaison	Henry County Government Cultural Liaison	Coordinates regional alignment

2. Cultural Advisory Network

(A broader group of stakeholders invited annually to review progress, offer ideas, and participate in working groups.)

- Local artists, performers, and musicians
- Gallery and studio owners
- Heritage and historical society members
- Representatives from Henry County Tourism and Chamber of Commerce
- Educators and librarians from Henry County School District and McDonough Library
- Downtown business owners and restaurateurs
- Neighborhood association leaders (Blacksville, Wesley Lakes, etc.)

- Local media representatives (Henry Herald, WJGA Radio)
- Civic organizations (Rotary, Kiwanis, Junior Women’s Club)
- Regional arts agencies (Georgia Council for the Arts, Atlanta Regional Commission)
- University partners (Mercer University, Clayton State University)
- Faith community and cultural-diversity advocates
- Youth organizations (Boys & Girls Club, Henry Arts Alliance Youth Council)

3. Staff & Administrative Support

Position	Affiliation	Function
Cultural Coordinator (full-time)	City of McDonough	Oversees day-to-day implementation, budgeting, reporting
Administrative Assistant (shared)	City of McDonough / Main Street	Provides scheduling, communications, and document support
Finance Liaison	City Finance Department	Manages Cultural Investment Fund accounts
Grant Writer / Development Officer	Contracted or shared role	Secures state, federal, and philanthropic funding
Communications Officer	City PIO or contracted designer	Manages website, social media, and marketing for cultural programming

Evaluation & Metrics Consultant	Contracted specialist	Tracks KPIs, prepares annual reports, and impact studies
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4. Sub-Committees & Working Groups (2026–2031)

Working Group	Purpose / Scope	Lead Organization
Heritage & Preservation Group	Protect historic assets; plan heritage trails and interpretation	Historic Preservation Commission
Public Art & Creative Expression Group	Commission artworks, murals, sculpture trail; manage artist calls	Main Street + Arts Representatives
Cultural Tourism & Economic Development Group	Develop festivals, marketing, and cultural-tourism packages	Economic Development + Visitors Bureau
Community Engagement & Equity Group	Ensure equitable access, community participation, and youth engagement	Neighborhood & Nonprofit Reps
Education & Youth Programs Group	Integrate arts into schools, youth mentorship, and career pathways	Henry County Schools + Museums
Funding & Sustainability Group	Oversee Cultural Investment Fund, grants, and sponsorships	Finance Department + Corporate Partners

5. Partner Institutions & Organizations

(Formal Memoranda of Understanding to be developed by 2027.)

- **City of McDonough Government** (Mayor, City Council, Department Heads)
 - **Main Street McDonough Program**
 - **Henry County Convention & Visitors Bureau**
 - **Henry County Chamber of Commerce**
 - **Henry County Board of Education / Fine Arts Department**
 - **Henry County Historical Society**
 - **C.O. Polk Interactive Museum**
 - **McDonough Camera Museum**
 - **Hood Street Art Center**
 - **Windsor Gallery**
 - **Henry Arts Alliance**
 - **Blacksville Neighborhood Association**
 - **Mercer University / Center for Community Engagement**
 - **Georgia Council for the Arts**
 - **Atlanta Regional Commission** (Arts & Culture Division)
 - **Local Nonprofit Partners** (e.g., Hands On Henry, Connecting Henry, community centers)
 - **Faith Community Coalition of McDonough**
 - **Private-Sector Sponsors** (local developers, banks, restaurants, and small businesses)
-

6. Terms of Service

- **Steering Committee:** Appointed for five-year term (2026–2031) with staggered rotation to ensure continuity.
 - **Advisory Network:** Open enrollment; reviewed annually.
 - **Working Groups:** Formed as needed for projects; report quarterly to Steering Committee.
 - **Chair and Vice Chair:** Elected by committee every two years.
 - **Youth and Community Seats:** Rotating annually to ensure diverse participation.
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7. Reporting & Transparency

- Publish **Annual Cultural Progress Report** each spring (starting 2027).
 - Maintain a **public online dashboard** tracking events, investments, and metrics.
 - Hold **Community Cultural Forum** every February for public feedback and idea generation.
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Appendix B — Funding Sources and Sustainability Framework (2026 – 2031)

1. Overview

The McDonough Cultural Plan (2026–2031) requires an estimated **annual investment of \$250,000 – \$400,000**, scaling with program growth.

Funding will blend **public allocations, private partnerships, grants, and earned revenue**, building a self-reinforcing cultural economy.

2. Core Funding Streams

Category	Description	Responsible Party
Municipal Allocation (General Fund)	Annual contribution from City of McDonough for staffing, basic programming, and maintenance of public art & cultural assets.	City Council, Finance Dept.
Cultural Investment Fund	Dedicated account established 2026 to pool City allocations, grants, sponsorships, and earned income; used for grants, residencies, festivals, and infrastructure.	Cultural Coordinator, Finance Dept.
Downtown Development Authority / Main Street Funds	Reinvestment of façade-grant and streetscape budgets toward creative-use renovations and public art projects.	Main Street McDonough + DDA
Tourism Product Development (Hotel-Motel Tax)	Allocation of up to 15 % of eligible revenues to cultural and heritage tourism initiatives.	City Tourism / Finance

Henry County Partnerships	Matching funds from County Economic Development or Tourism offices for county-wide arts programming.	County Liaison
State & Federal Grants	Competitive awards from state and national arts, humanities, and economic-development programs (see Section 3).	Grant Writer / Funding & Sustainability Group
Corporate Sponsorships	Annual sponsorship packages for festivals, murals, and public events.	Economic Development + Private Sector Rep
Philanthropic Foundations	Multi-year grants from Georgia and regional foundations supporting equity, education, and creative economy.	Cultural Coordinator
Earned Revenue	Festival ticketing, vendor fees, cultural-tourism packages, studio rentals, and merchandise.	Cultural Coordinator
In-Kind Contributions	Donated materials, spaces, or professional services.	All Partners

3. Grant and External Funding Opportunities

A. State of Georgia Programs

- **Georgia Council for the Arts (GCA)** — Partner, Project, and Vibrant Communities Grants.
- **Georgia Department of Community Affairs (DCA)** — Downtown Development Revolving Loan Fund, Rural Zone Credits for creative reuse.

- **Georgia Department of Economic Development (GDEcD)** — Tourism Product Development Grants.
- **Georgia Humanities** — Public-programming and interpretation grants.
- **Historic Preservation Division (DNR)** — Certified Local Government (CLG) grants for heritage interpretation.
- **Georgia Municipal Association (GMA)** — Civic innovation micro-grants for arts-based placemaking.

B. Federal Programs

- **National Endowment for the Arts (NEA)** — Challenge America, Our Town, Grants for Arts Projects.
- **National Endowment for the Humanities (NEH)** — Public humanities and museum interpretation.
- **Institute of Museum and Library Services (IMLS)** — Museums for America & Inspire! Grants.
- **Economic Development Administration (EDA)** — Infrastructure funding for creative industry districts.
- **National Park Service** — African-American Civil Rights & Historic Preservation Fund (for Blacksville heritage work).

C. Foundations & Private Sources

- **Knight Foundation** — Creative Cities and Community Arts.
- **Kresge Foundation** — Arts & Culture / Creative Placemaking.
- **Arthur M. Blank Family Foundation** — Georgia cultural and civic projects.
- **Home Depot Foundation** — Historic preservation and community revitalization.
- **Community Foundation for Greater Atlanta** — Local arts, equity, and neighborhood revitalization grants.

- **Bank of America Charitable Foundation** — Economic mobility through creative workforce development.

4. Private-Sector & Corporate Engagement

Mechanism	Description	Target Partners
Annual Cultural Sponsorship Program	Tiered sponsorship (Gold \$25k+, Silver \$10k+, Bronze \$5k) for festivals, murals, events.	Local banks, utilities, real-estate groups, regional corporations
Adopt-a-Mural / Public Art Piece	Companies sponsor specific installations with recognition plaques.	Construction, design, and retail firms
Creative Business Incentives	Rent-subsidy or tax credit for creative tenants in downtown buildings.	Downtown property owners
Corporate Volunteer Program	Staff volunteer hours for event logistics, mentorship, and art installation.	Chamber of Commerce members

5. Earned-Income Strategies (2027 – 2031)

1. **Signature Festival** — Ticket sales, vendor fees, and concessions (goal: \$50k net by 2029).
2. **Cultural Hub Studio Rentals** — Workspace leasing for artists and makers (goal: \$25k annual income by 2030).
3. **Merchandise & Prints** — “Creative McDonough” branding line for local retail.
4. **Workshops & Classes** — Fee-based community programs and residencies.

5. **Cultural Tours** — Paid historic and art-walk tours in partnership with tourism bureau.
-

6. Financial Governance

- **Custodianship:** City Finance Department maintains the Cultural Investment Fund.
 - **Reporting:** Quarterly budget reports to Steering Committee; annual public audit.
 - **Grant Management:** All grant funds tracked by purpose; quarterly compliance reviews.
 - **Sponsorship Policy:** Written ethical guidelines to ensure transparency and civic alignment.
 - **Matching Requirement:** Every City dollar leveraged by at least 1:1 in external or private support by 2028.
-

7. Budget Projections (Illustrative)

Year	City Allocation	Grants & External	Private / Corporate	Earned Revenue	Total Available
2026	\$150,000	\$75,000	\$25,000	\$10,000	\$260,000
2027	\$175,000	\$100,000	\$50,000	\$25,000	\$350,000
2028	\$200,000	\$125,000	\$75,000	\$35,000	\$435,000
2029	\$225,000	\$150,000	\$100,000	\$50,000	\$525,000

2030	\$250,000	\$150,000	\$125,000	\$60,000	\$585,000
2031	\$250,000	\$175,000	\$125,000	\$75,000	\$625,000

(figures illustrative; adjust annually based on grants and sponsorship yields)

8. Sustainability Framework

A. Structural Sustainability

- Institutionalize the Cultural Coordinator role in city staffing plan.
- Embed annual line-item in municipal budget.
- Maintain cross-departmental integration (Planning, Parks, Economic Dev.).

B. Financial Sustainability

- Maintain reserve of 10 % of prior year’s revenues within Cultural Investment Fund.
- Pursue multi-year grants (3-year commitments) by 2028.
- Secure private-sector endowment pledges for public art and heritage.

C. Programmatic Sustainability

- Rotate festival and art commissions to distribute benefits.
- Develop inter-generational leadership via youth & community seats.
- Document best practices in a living “McDonough Cultural Toolkit.”

D. Evaluation & Transparency

- Publish annual public report with financial and impact metrics.

- Host annual Cultural Forum for citizen review of spending and outcomes.

9. Risk Management

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Insufficient grant success	Medium	Broaden pipeline; hire part-time grant specialist
Corporate sponsorship decline	Medium	Diversify sponsors, add earned-revenue programs
City budget contraction	High	Maintain reserve fund; prioritize essential programs
Event weather or attendance risk	Medium	Secure insurance; plan indoor contingency
Grant compliance issues	Low	Implement strict tracking; annual audits

10. Timeline for Funding Development

Year	Milestones
2026	Establish Cultural Investment Fund; apply for GCA Vibrant Communities Grant; secure 2 corporate sponsors.
2027	Launch annual sponsorship program; apply NEA Our Town; initiate festival revenue stream.

2028 Secure 3-year foundation grant; initiate creative-industry rent-incentive pilot.

2029 Build festival reserve fund; reach 1:1 external match for City funding.

2030 – Launch endowment campaign for long-term sustainability.
2031

11. Summary

By combining **city investment, grant leverage, private-sector partnerships, and earned-income models**, McDonough can sustain its cultural plan beyond 2031.

A diversified, transparent funding architecture will secure not only programs but also trust—ensuring that culture remains a **permanent, vital part of McDonough’s civic infrastructure**.

Appendix C — Evaluation Metrics & Performance Dashboard (2026 – 2031)

1. Purpose

The evaluation system ensures that every program, event, and investment under the McDonough Cultural Plan produces measurable community value.

It tracks **inputs** → **outputs** → **outcomes** → **impact**, connecting day-to-day actions with long-term goals of economic vitality, inclusion, and civic pride.

2. Evaluation Framework

Level	Definition	Examples
Inputs	Resources invested (funds, staff, partners)	City allocations, grants, sponsorships
Outputs	Activities delivered	Number of events, workshops, or artworks completed
Outcomes	Short-term results	Increased participation, tourism spending
Impacts	Long-term effects	Stronger local identity, creative-economy growth, community cohesion

3. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

A. Heritage & Place-Making

Objective	Indicator	Target 2031	Data Source
Preserve & activate heritage assets	Historic buildings adaptively reused for cultural purposes	+15 sites converted since 2026	City Planning / HPC permits
Heritage interpretation & tourism	Interpretive signs, digital tours, or AR heritage points	25 installed city-wide	Cultural Coordinator
Aesthetic improvement	Façade-grant projects completed	≥ 30	DDA / Main Street
Public art density	Public art pieces per sq mile downtown	10 → 20	Public Art Registry
Community satisfaction	Residents reporting “pride in downtown heritage”	+25 % vs 2026 baseline	Annual Survey

B. Arts, Creativity & Community Expression

Objective	Indicator	Target 2031	Data Source
Expand creative opportunities	Artists supported through residencies, grants, or exhibitions	250 artists over 5 yrs	Program Records
Youth engagement	Students involved in cultural programs annually	1,000 per year by 2030	Schools / Museums
Accessibility	Free public events per year	50 +	Event Database

Creative-industry growth	Creative businesses operating in McDonough	+30 % increase	Business Licensing Data
Audience reach	Cumulative event attendance	50,000 visits per year	Ticket + Survey Data

C. Culture, Economy & Tourism

Objective	Indicator	Target 2031	Data Source
Economic impact	Direct visitor spending from cultural tourism	\$1 M annual	Tourism Bureau
Downtown vitality	Retail + restaurant occupancy rate	≥ 95 %	DDA / Chamber
Signature festival	Annual attendance	20,000 + visitors	Festival Records
Cultural jobs	Full-time equivalent positions in cultural sector	+50 jobs by 2031	Econ Dev Dept.
Creative investment leverage	External \$ per City \$ invested	≥ 2 : 1	Finance Dept.

D. Community Engagement & Equity

Objective	Indicator	Target 2031	Data Source
Equity in access	% of programs held outside downtown core	≥ 40 %	Cultural Coordinator
Diversity of participation	Demographic mix mirrors city population	Parity achieved	Registration surveys
Neighborhood inclusion	Active neighborhood cultural groups	5 by 2030	Outreach Logs
Volunteerism	Volunteer hours annually	2,000 +	Volunteer Database
Community perception	“Culture improves quality of life” responses	> 80 % agree	Annual Survey

4. Annual Evaluation Process

Quarter	Action	Responsible Party
Q1 (Jan–Mar)	Data collection from prior year (events, budgets, attendance).	Cultural Coordinator + Dept. Reps
Q2 (Apr–Jun)	Steering Committee review; draft “State of Culture Report.”	Steering Committee

Q3 (Jul–Sep)	Publish public dashboard update; community forum for feedback.	Communications Officer
Q4 (Oct–Dec)	Adjust programs and budget based on metrics; set next-year goals.	City Council / Cultural Staff

5. Reporting Tools

- **Public Online Dashboard:** Interactive charts showing attendance, funding, and project maps (updated quarterly).
 - **Annual Cultural Report:** PDF + print version each spring summarizing achievements, metrics, testimonials.
 - **Community Forum:** Annual February gathering for residents, partners, and artists to review outcomes and suggest improvements.
 - **Five-Year Audit (2031):** Independent evaluation by external consultant measuring cumulative impact, economic return, and equity indicators.
-

6. Sample Dashboard Layout

Metric	2026 Baseline	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031 Goal
Cultural Events / Year	18	30	45	55	60	65
Attendance	9 k	15 k	25 k	35 k	45 k	50 k +
Artists Supported	40	75	120	180	220	250
Heritage Sites Restored	2	5	8	12	15	20
Public Art Installations	3	6	10	14	18	22
Cultural Funding (\$ k)	260	350	435	525	585	625
Resident Satisfaction (%)	54	60	68	72	78	82

7. Qualitative Evaluation

Beyond numbers, annual reviews will collect:

- **Resident testimonials** (quotes, short videos) on cultural participation.
- **Case studies** of transformative projects (e.g., a mural revitalizing a block).
- **Press coverage & social-media sentiment analysis.**
- **Youth feedback reports** via student advisory seat.

- **Partner evaluations** (business owners, nonprofits, schools).

These narratives reinforce quantitative data with lived experience.

8. Accountability & Transparency Measures

- All metrics and financial data published on the **City website and open-data portal**.
 - Annual report submitted to **Mayor & Council**, then shared publicly.
 - Steering Committee members sign an **Ethics & Transparency Charter**.
 - Independent auditor verifies spending alignment with plan goals every two years.
-

9. Adjustment Cycle

- If $\geq 30\%$ of KPIs fall below threshold for two consecutive years → convene **Strategic Review Session** to redesign underperforming programs.
 - Biennial “Mini-Plan Update” keeps goals relevant to emerging opportunities (e.g., new technologies, demographic shifts).
 - By 2031, all data inform development of **Cultural Plan 2032 – 2037**.
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10. Summary

This dashboard creates a **living measurement system**—transparent, data-driven, and community-owned. It allows McDonough to demonstrate the tangible return on investment in culture, ensuring that by 2031 the city can prove that arts, heritage, and creativity are not expenses but **core civic infrastructure** that strengthen community identity, economy, and well-being.

Appendix D — Implementation Calendar (2026 – 2031)

Legend

- **CC** = Cultural Coordinator
 - **SC** = Steering Committee
 - **MS** = Main Street McDonough
 - **ED** = Economic Development Dept.
 - **P&R** = Parks & Recreation
 - **HPC** = Historic Preservation Commission
 - **HCS** = Henry County Schools / Education Partners
 - **CVB** = Convention & Visitors Bureau
 - **COM** = Community & Neighborhood Reps
 - **FD** = Finance Dept.
 - **EXT** = External Contractor / Consultant
-

2026 — Foundation & Launch Year

Quarter	Major Tasks	Lead Party	Key Partners
Q1 (Jan–Mar)	Appoint Steering Committee & Working Groups · Hire Cultural Coordinator · Establish Cultural Investment Fund · Adopt implementation charter	CC / SC / City Council	FD · Mayor’s Office
Q2 (Apr–Jun)	Conduct city-wide cultural asset inventory · Launch community survey · Hold first public forum · Set baseline KPIs	CC	COM · MS · HPC
Q3 (Jul–Sep)	Develop branding (“Creative McDonough”) · Design pilot downtown heritage trail signage · Apply for GCA grants	CC / MS	ED · CVB · HPC
Q4 (Oct–Dec)	Pilot one public-art installation · Publish Year-End “State of Culture 2026” report	CC / SC	P&R · Artists

2027 — Pilot Programs & Early Visibility

Quarter	Major Tasks	Lead Party	Key Partners
Q1	Finalize festival concept · Plan artist-in-residence framework · Initiate façade-grant guidelines	SC / ED	DDA · MS
Q2	Launch monthly Art Walks · Host youth-arts pilot in partnership with HCS	CC	HCS · COM
Q3	Secure NEA Our Town application · Expand trail signage · Announce first Creative Grant Cycle	CC / FD	Grant Writer · HPC
Q4	Launch downtown mural series · Publish first Annual Cultural Report · Hold public forum #2	CC	CVB · Artists · Residents

2028 — Expansion & Festival Launch

Quarter	Major Tasks	Lead Party	Key Partners
Q1	Recruit first artist residents · Select festival vendors · Roll out neighborhood heritage circuits	CC / HPC	COM · MS
Q2	Launch McDonough Arts & Heritage Festival · Implement creative-business incentive pilot	CC / ED	CVB · DDA · FD
Q3	Evaluate festival impact · Begin Creative Hub planning · Apply for multi-year foundation grant	CC / EXT	FD · SC
Q4	Expand youth mentorship program · Host mid-year neighborhood showcases · Publish metrics	CC / HCS	COM · Nonprofits

2029 — Mid-Plan Consolidation & Summit

Quarter	Major Tasks	Lead Party	Key Partners
Q1	Hold McDonough Creative Summit · Review KPIs · Adjust strategy	SC / CC	ED · CVB
Q2	Expand façade-grant program · Launch second Creative Grant Cycle · Add new murals corridor	CC / ED	MS · Artists

Q3	Launch cultural tourism packages · Partner with regional arts network · Evaluate Creative Hub site	CC / CVB	ARC · County
Q4	Publish Mid-Term Audit Report · Present findings to Council · Update Plan for Phase II	CC / SC	FD · City Council

2030 — Cultural Hub & Regional Integration

Quarter	Major Tasks	Lead Party	Key Partners
Q1	Open McDonough Creative Hub (pilot space) · Install new public art trail	CC / ED	DDA · Artists
Q2	Apply for Cultural District Designation · Launch AR/VR heritage tour prototype	CC / HPC / EXT	Tech Partners · CVB
Q3	Expand Creative Business Incentives · Develop school-industry internships	CC / HCS	ED · County
Q4	Second Creative Summit · Release “Five Years of Culture” retrospective film	CC / Communications	Artists · Schools

2031 — Evaluation & Transition to Next Plan

Quarter	Major Tasks	Lead Party	Key Partners
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Q1	Commission independent Five-Year Audit · Begin Community Consultations for 2032-2037 Plan	CC / EXT	SC · COM
Q2	Host final Cultural Forum · Gather public input on future priorities · Draft new vision	SC / CC	City Council · Residents
Q3	Publish comprehensive Cultural Impact Report 2016–2031 · Archive data to city portal	CC / FD	Communications
Q4	Formal adoption of Next Five-Year Plan · Transition of Steering Committee membership	City Council / SC	Mayor’s Office

Cross-Year Standing Actions (All Years)

Activity	Frequency	Lead
Steering Committee Meetings	Quarterly	SC Chair
Financial Reporting to Council	Quarterly	FD + CC
Community Cultural Forum	Annual (February)	CC + COM
Annual Cultural Report	Every April	CC + Communications
Grant Applications / Renewals	Rolling	Grant Writer + FD

Public Art Maintenance Review	Semi-Annual	P&R + Artists
KPI Monitoring & Dashboard Update	Quarterly	CC + EXT
Volunteer & Youth Recruitment	Ongoing	COM + HCS

Sequencing Summary

Year	Focus Theme	Defining Output
2026	Foundation & Coordination	Steering Committee + Cultural Fund established
2027	Visibility & Pilot Programs	First Art Walk + Mural + Grant Cycle
2028	Expansion & Festival Launch	McDonough Arts & Heritage Festival debut
2029	Integration & Regional Partnerships	Creative Summit + Tourism Packages
2030	Innovation & Infrastructure	Opening of Creative Hub + AR Tours
2031	Evaluation & Renewal	Five-Year Audit + Next Plan Adoption

Governance Checkpoints

- **Annual Review:** Every December — Steering Committee evaluates progress against KPIs (Appendix C).
 - **Mid-Term Audit:** End of 2028 → course correction for 2030–31 cycle.
 - **Five-Year Audit:** Q1 2031 → independent assessment to shape next Cultural Plan.
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Appendix E — Communications & Public Engagement Strategy (2026 – 2031)

1. Purpose

To create an inclusive, transparent, and inspiring communications framework that keeps residents, artists, and partners informed, involved, and proud of McDonough’s cultural growth.

The strategy ensures that the Cultural Plan is not just a government document but a **living civic movement**.

2. Guiding Principles

1. **Transparency:** All cultural investments and outcomes publicly accessible.
 2. **Inclusivity:** Every neighborhood and demographic represented in messaging and imagery.
 3. **Consistency:** Unified visual identity and tone across all City and partner platforms.
 4. **Participation:** Two-way dialogue—communication as invitation, not broadcast.
 5. **Celebration:** Culture presented as a point of pride and shared ownership.
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3. Branding & Identity

Element	Description	Responsibility
Brand Name	Creative McDonough — the public-facing identity for all cultural initiatives.	CC + Communications Team
Visual System	Logo integrating courthouse silhouette + sunburst motif; palette reflecting heritage brick reds, golden neutrals, and vivid festival hues.	Contracted Designer

Tagline	“Where Heritage Inspires Tomorrow.”	Steering Committee
Tone & Voice	Friendly · Civic · Optimistic · Rooted in local storytelling.	Communications Officer

Deliverables (2026–2027):

- Brand standards manual
- Photography library (people + places + events)
- Template set (press release, poster, social media, signage)

4. Target Audiences

Audience Group	Communication Focus
Residents	Local pride, participation opportunities, volunteerism
Artists & Creatives	Calls for art, grants, residencies, studio access
Businesses & Developers	Sponsorship, cultural-district benefits
Educators & Students	Youth programs, field trips, internships
Tourists & Visitors	Events calendar, heritage attractions
Regional Partners	Collaboration, funding, data sharing

Media & Influencers Story leads, success metrics, human-interest pieces

5. Communication Channels

Platform	Function	Frequency
City Website – Culture Portal	Central hub with dashboard, calendar, reports, grant info	Updated weekly
Social Media (@CreativeMcDonough)	Facebook · Instagram · X · YouTube · TikTok (Reels of events, artists)	3–5 posts per week
Email Newsletter	“Creative Dispatch” monthly digest	Monthly
Local Media Partnerships	Henry Herald · WJGA Radio · Atlanta arts press	Press releases per event
Physical Signage & Bulletins	Posters in downtown, libraries, schools	Monthly rotation
Community Meetings & Forums	Live dialogue and updates	Quarterly
Annual Cultural Report Launch	Press event + online publication	April each year

6. Public Engagement Phases

Phase 1 – Awareness (2026 – 2027)

- Launch brand and website.
- Conduct listening sessions in each neighborhood.
- Introduce monthly “Culture Minute” video updates.
- Partner with schools for “Youth Voices in Culture” art contest.

Phase 2 – Participation (2028 – 2029)

- “Join the Movement” campaign recruiting volunteers.
- Pop-up art labs in parks and shopping centers.
- Festival ambassador program (resident hosts).
- Biannual cultural roundtables with civic and business groups.

Phase 3 – Legacy (2030 – 2031)

- Documentary project: *Five Years of Creative McDonough*.
- Traveling exhibit summarizing achievements.
- Public storytelling campaign: residents share “My McDonough Moment.”
- Citywide vote or mural unveiling to close the plan cycle.

7. Community Engagement Mechanisms

Engagement Tool

Purpose

Frequency

Neighborhood Cultural Ambassadors	Local liaisons bridging neighborhoods & City	10 appointed by 2027
Youth Advisory Council	Student perspective on programs	Monthly meetings
Community Cultural Forum	Open public session on progress	Annual (February)
Online Idea Portal	Residents propose projects, vote on art concepts	Live from 2026
Public Art Dedications	Ribbon-cutting + storytelling moments	As projects complete

8. Media & Public Relations Plan

Key Actions

1. Maintain annual media contact list (local + regional).
2. Issue press releases for all major milestones (launches, grants, installations).
3. Pitch quarterly feature stories highlighting artists, volunteers, or youth.
4. Provide high-resolution imagery and data visuals for journalists.
5. Host annual press breakfast before festival season.
6. Track earned-media value quarterly for KPI reporting.

9. Accessibility & Equity Commitments

- All printed materials bilingual (English + Spanish).
- ADA-compliant website and captioned video content.
- Free admission or pay-what-you-can options for all city-produced events.

- Outreach to underrepresented neighborhoods prioritized through on-site meetings.
- Diversity review of imagery and language annually by Equity Working Group.

10. Metrics for Communications Success

Category	Indicator	Target by 2031
Awareness	Social-media reach	25 k followers across platforms
Engagement	Event attendance driven by digital channels	50 % increase from baseline
Transparency	Annual reports downloaded	2 000 + unique downloads
Participation	Volunteers registered through campaigns	500 residents
Media Coverage	Positive press mentions / year	50 + local/regional
Equity	Neighborhood representation in engagement events	≥ 90 % of neighborhoods reached

11. Annual Communication Calendar (Example)

Month	Highlight Activity	Primary Medium
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January	“State of Culture” press conference	Local press + live stream
February	Community Cultural Forum	Town Hall + social polls
March	Heritage Trail Stories Launch	YouTube mini-series
April	Annual Cultural Report release	Website + email
June	Summer Pop-Up Art Labs	Instagram campaign
August	Youth Voices Festival	Schools + TikTok Reels
October	Public Art Week + Volunteer Day	Downtown activation
December	“Year in Culture” video recap	City channels + press

12. Staffing & Budget

Role	% Time	Function
Cultural Coordinator	25 %	Oversees strategy + content approval
Communications Officer	50 %	Day-to-day execution, media relations
Graphic Designer (contract)	As needed	Brand materials, templates
Videographer (contract)	Seasonal	Storytelling + recaps
Neighborhood Ambassadors	Volunteer stipends	Local outreach + distribution

Estimated annual communications budget: **\$45,000 – \$60,000** (within Cultural Fund).

13. Crisis & Reputation Management

- **Spokesperson:** Mayor or designated Communications Officer.
 - **Rapid Response Protocol:** Acknowledge within 24 hours, issue verified update within 72 hours.
 - **Core Principle:** Transparency > Spin — trust through honesty.
 - **Review Cycle:** Post-incident debrief to improve procedures.
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14. Long-Term Outcome

By 2031, McDonough should be recognized regionally as a **model small-city cultural communications ecosystem**—where residents see themselves represented, visitors feel welcomed, and every public space tells a story of shared heritage and creativity.

15. Planning Committee Members:

Message from the Office of the Mayor

The *Cultural Plan for the City of McDonough, Georgia (2026–2031)* is the result of a truly collaborative effort that began with the reopening of the C.O. Polk Interactive Museum. Through City Council discussions and meetings with museum stakeholders, it became clear that McDonough needed a comprehensive cultural plan to guide its future growth.

The City of McDonough extends its sincere appreciation to the members of the Cultural Planning Committee, community partners, and residents who contributed their time, ideas, and passion to this important initiative. Their dedication has produced an inclusive and forward-looking plan—one that serves not only our residents but also visitors, tourists, and businesses that make McDonough a thriving and welcoming community.

- Mayor Sandra Vincent
- City Administrator Steve Morgan
- Deputy City Administrator Andrew Baker
- Manager, Main Street & Welcome Center Cinderella Bennett
- Executive Assistant to the City Administrator Joani Clemons
- Mark Walhimer, (consultant), Museum Planning LLC
- Hope Vincent (contractor), Communications

